9.2.3 Shortened term-level queries

The `term` queries in listings 9.1 and 9.2 are shortened versions. While it is convenient to write the shortened version, let's take a moment to see the original full version of the query from listing 9.1.

Listing 9.3 Full syntax of a query

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "term": {
      "certificate": {
        "value": "R",
        "boost": 2
      }
    }
  }
}
```

The certificate field has values enclosed in an object.

The certificate's search criteria

In addition to the value, we can provide parameters like boost.

The `certificate` field expects an object with `value` and other parameters. `value`, which appears at the same level as the field in the shortened version, is one level lower than the field. The enclosed object can also host other attributes, such as `boost`, as in this example.

While the full version adds features to a query, the shortened version is straightforward and used extensively when a query is simple and needs no further tweaking. We use shortened versions throughout the book unless we are interested in working with other parameters.

So far, we have searched for words against a single field using a `term` query. A `term` query looks at exact matches for a single word, such as `"certificate":"R"`. But what if we want to search for multiple values in a single field? For example, how can we search for R-rated and PG-13 movies on the `certificate` field? That's where the `terms` query comes into the picture.

9.3 The terms query

As the name suggests, a `terms` (note the plural) query searches for multiple criteria against a single field. We can throw in all possible values of the field that we would like to search for. Say we want to search for all movies with multiple content ratings, such as PG-13 and R. We use a `terms` query for this purpose.

Listing 9.4 Searching for multiple search criteria in a field

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "terms": {
      "certificate": ["PG-13","R"]
    }
  }
}
```

The terms query expects an array of search criteria.

Multiple search criteria against a single field